

Vertigo

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No 821 September 2018



NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB

Wellington Section Monthly Bulletin

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Matthieu Laloup grimaces high above a watery atmosphere on The Moai. Ancient Astronaut (24), Fortescue Bay, Tasmania Rock Climbing Category and overall People's Choice winner, NZAC Wellington Section Photo Competition 2018. [More here](#)
Photo Derek Cheng

Chair's Report

September 2018

Well the election for the new governance has been and gone and there were enough votes for the change motion to pass. Celebrations and congratulations all round (well perhaps not for those few who voted against). But wait, voting for a change in governance for the club isn't the same thing as governing the club. I also voted in favor, but we are yet to see if the new structure can or will deliver any better than the last one. I very much hope it will, but we won't really know until it is in place and tested. What, I hear you all say, well one of you at least, will we test? Good question.

How will we know what difference the new governance arrangements make? For one, I would expect to see more effective project and associated financial management. I would also expect to see resolution of some long outstanding issues such as the website, as well as a more direct alignment between club objectives and activities. Last, I would hope to see a stronger relationship between the national office, governance and the sections. But these are my measures, you might have different ones, maybe stronger advocacy for access, or an all inclusive fit for purpose NZ alpine climbing manual (a la Freedom of the Hills), more huts or something else perhaps. So now that you have voted for it, what do you want from the new improved NZAC governance body?

"If you haven't got any skin in the game you aren't taking any risk. If you aren't taking any risk, you aren't making any difference or adding value". Simon Williamson 2018

If you have any comments on what you like or don't like send an email to wellington@alpineclub.org.nz or tweet us [@NZACWellington](https://twitter.com/NZACWellington).

Simon

From the Editor

We held our inaugural TGR ski movie night last week and sadly, got a lot less support than is needed to keep it going. We've had some mostly negative feedback about Vic Uni Memorial Theatre as the venue. But if you have other reasons for not wanting to come along, or if you did, to improve it, the Committee will welcome your feedback.

And, as usual, if you have a trip to share just type up a report of between half and three pages as a Word document, email it to occasionalclimber@gmail.com with one to six jpeg images and I'll format it for Vertigo.

Peter

Simon Williamson
Chair: NZAC Wellington

Section News

October Section night

From 6pm Wed 31st October, Nigel Roberts will present his journey up the highest peaks in each of USA's 50 states. We will also cover off AGM items at this gathering.

All Section night talks are held at The Third Eye, Tuatara Brewery, level 2, 30 Arthur Street, from 6pm. Also a good place to collect or return hired climbing gear.

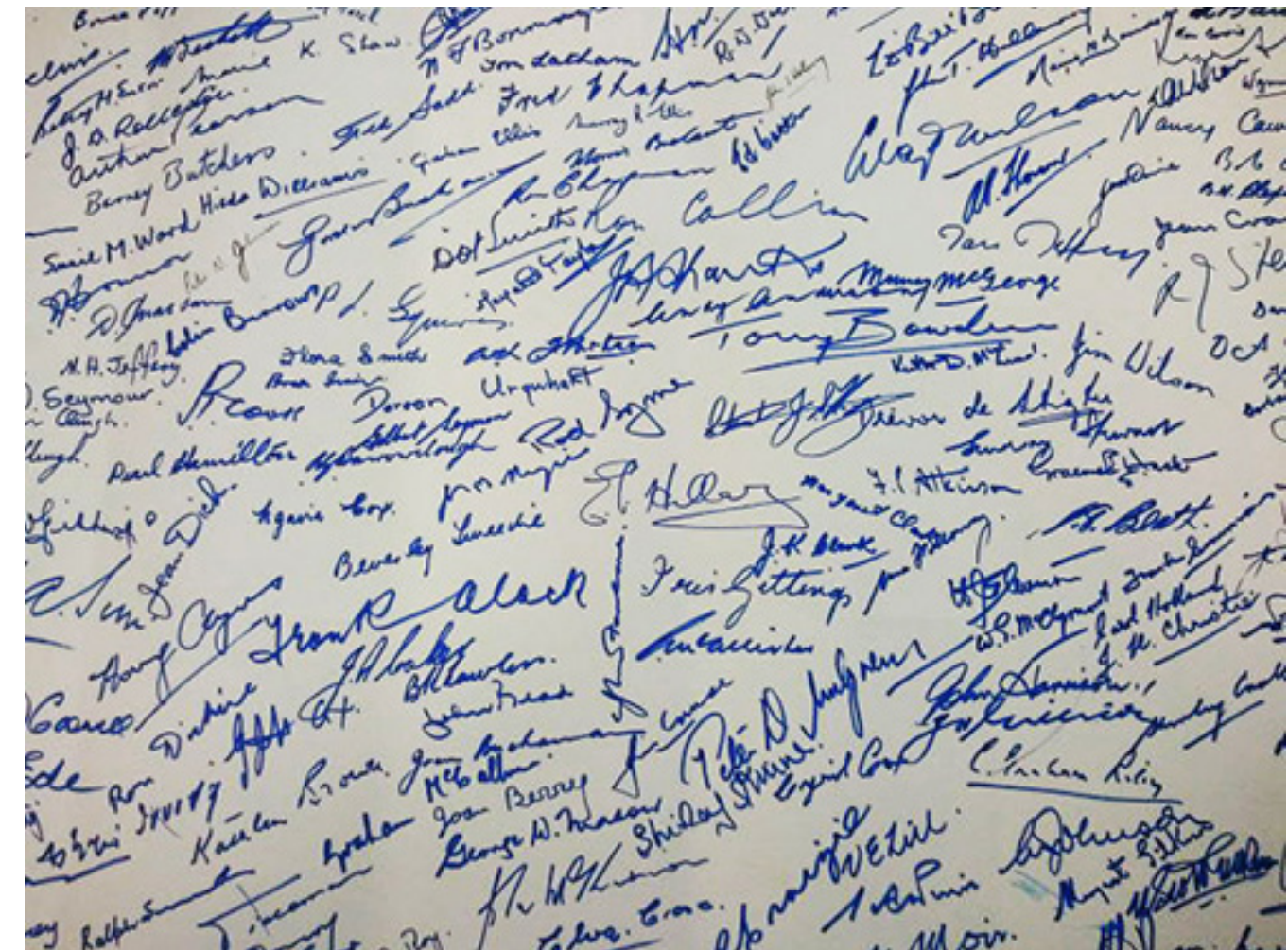
Section nights beyond October

Wed 28th November, Nina Sawicki will take us on a journey to Kanchenjunga base camp in Nepal.

No section nights December and January.

Wed 27th February 2019, climbing and pizzas at Hangdogs TBC

Wed 27th March, Paul Maxim will talk about peaks, places and prints - as a climber and writer, how he has been able to very successfully combined these two interests.



This A3 size poster of signatures of some of our most prominent Club members has nothing written on it to explain the where, or when this was done. If you know anything about this please contact [Margaret](#) at the NZAC National Office.

Section News

Gear Hire

Don't forget the Section has gear for hire: avalanche transceivers, ice axes, shovels, stakes, hammers, helmets, crampons, probes, PLBs, ice hammers (entry level).

To hire gear please fill in the form [here](#). Why not come to a last Wednesday of the month Section evening to collect or return gear.

Each item costs \$5 per week with the exception of PLBs – PLBs are free but require a deposit of \$50 refundable on return.

A little bit of advance notice would be appreciated as gear often needs to be retrieved from the gear store in Lower Hutt. Gear collections and drop-offs are usually available in the city during the working day or at section night.

Accommodation on Mt Ruapehu

Our snowcraft courses for the past few years have been run out of the Manawatu Tramping and Skiing Club lodge on Whakapapa. We're always made to feel welcome and the lodge is well situated a short walk from the top of the Bruce Road. Membership to the club is extremely reasonable - \$35 per year or \$50 for a family membership. Members stay at the lodge for \$36 a night including food. If you're looking for somewhere to base yourself for your winter pursuits or rock-climbing over the summer months go to www.mtsc.org.nz/joining.php to find out more about joining the club.

A Walk in the Park?

A deep dive into tramping incidents in New Zealand. Find out [more](#).

Expedition Fund 2018 [Call for Applications and Donations](#)

XII ISMM World Congress On Mountain Medicine

21-24 November 2018, Kathmandu, Nepal, www.ismm2018.org, [email](#)

Nominations open for NZAC Volunteer of the Year 2018

NZAC Volunteer of the Year (VOTY) is awarded at each AGM. Individuals and Sections nominate an NZAC volunteer that they think have done great work over the course of the previous year. Please complete the [online nomination form](#) no later than 1 Oct 18.

UIAA ice climbing season

The calendar for the 2019 UIAA ice climbing season is now in place. Read [more](#). Also the Global Rock and Ice Climbing Festivals: all in one place [here](#).

International Snow Science Workshop preliminary programme [here](#)

Bisotun 4th Festival of Big wall Climbing Iran

Kermanshah 20th to 27th October 2018

More details [here](#).

Notices

NZAC instruction courses open for registration

Click for more details [Ice Climbing](#) [Ski Touring](#) (and the new guide [here](#)) [High Alpine Skills](#)

[Ski-fields](#) offering NZAC members a discount for the 2018 season

NZAC Mountain Medicine Weekend

NZAC Unwin Lodge Aoraki Mt Cook will be hosting its first ever weekend of Mountain Medicine workshops this 13/14 October. The weekend will offer climbers, trampers, mountaineers and skiers the chance to learn about mountain medicine from experts in the field and share knowledge and experience with others interested in Mountain Medicine. [Click](#) to read the full event/workshop info and to register.

2018 UIAA Mountain Protection Award - applications now open

As a member of the UIAA the NZAC is eligible to enter individual or group projects for this award. Please email the General Manager, [Karen Tait](#), if you have a project for entry. The UIAA Mountain Protection Award (MPA) was created in 2013. During its six years of existence, the annual UIAA Mountain Protection Award (MPA) has made a tangible difference to mountain lives, communities and the environment. It has enabled people to raise finances to build key infrastructures, conduct vital research and fulfil pending goals; it has provided an international showcase and communication platform for projects to raise awareness and exchange ideas and initiatives. Not only has it supported local communities, it has fostered its own global community. The Award celebrates innovation and a desire to make a difference. [Click](#) for more.

Is your KiwiSaver account in a Socially Responsible Investment (SRI*) fund?

Align your fund with your values

Responsible investment is a process that takes into account environmental, social, governance (ESG) and ethical issues; including pollution, resource over-use and child labour

Time to change?

Contact me to discuss your options

Keith Munro KiwiSaver and Mortgage Adviser 027 654 6568 keithm@mtgelab.co.nz

*SRI may specifically exclude investments in:
• Alcohol production • Gambling operations • Tobacco production, distribution, supply & retailing • Military weapons manufacturing • Civilian firearms production, distribution, supply & retailing • Nuclear power production & uranium mining • Fossil fuels exploration, extraction, refinement, distribution, supply & retailing • Adult entertainment content production • Genetically modified organisms, excluding research & Development



Coming Trips, Courses, Events

All our planned South Island trips come with the added bonus that rental vehicle costs for Wellington Section members are covered by the Section.

If you're uncertain about the skill level required with any of the trips, would like to register your interest or to find out more, email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Also, please contact us if you're keen to run a trip yourself – the Committee can help with advertising and logistics.

When	What and where
5 to 7 October	North Island Ski Touring Meet 2018 Based at Tukino Lodge, Mt Ruapehu <u>Info Pack</u> <u>Registration</u> Please <u>contact Mac</u> with any questions A great opportunity to find likeminded people, enjoy some spring ski touring adventures with them and explore Ruapehu's wild side, away from the busy ski fields. Please note this is not a led trip, so when on the meet, groups will need to be able to look after yourselves when away from the lodge.
19 to 22 October (Labour weekend)	Wellington Section Climbing Meet - Paines Ford, Takaka Contact <u>Eric Duggan</u> for more information or to confirm your spot.
19 to 22 October TBC (Labour weekend)	Alpine climbing trip If a trip leader can be identified, all their costs plus rental car will be covered by the Club. Contact <u>Simon Williamson</u> to express interest.
16 to 19 November	Wellington Section Climbing Meet - Paines Ford, Takaka Contact <u>Eric Duggan</u> for more information or to confirm your spot For members, your transport from the airport to Hangdog Camp ground is subsidised. This is a climbing meet, not an instruction course. You must be able to belay and lead in an outdoor environment and have your own safety and climbing equipment. It is not required to have rope or quickdraws but you need to buddy up with others that have them. Hangdog Camp grounds is the usual accomm situation but you can organise alternative accommodation.
Late November TBC	Nuns Veil Maximum 6, contact <u>Simon Williamson</u> for more information and to express interest. Section will cover rental car cost from Christchurch.
7 to 10 December	Wellington Section Climbing Meet - Castle Hill Contact <u>Stacey Wong</u> for more information or to confirm your spot.
13 - 27 April 2019	Wellington Section Trip to Arapiles Please email your expression of interest to <u>Jenny Cossey</u> Fly to Melbourne individually and leave by car in a group from Melbourne on Saturday 13th April. Returning by car to Melbourne on Saturday 27th April. Please note these are the two weeks of the NZ school holidays which includes Good Friday (19th April), Easter Monday (22nd April) and ANZAC Day (25th April). Please book your own air tickets early to suit you. The Wellington section will give a subsidy towards car hire for the trip for a maximum of ten section members who register with the trip organiser Jenny Cossey on a first come first served basis.



Alric on the Grand Pinnacle, July 2018. Photo Paul McCredy
Apline Activity Category Honours, 2018 Wellington Section Photo Competition



Sunrise over Aoraki/Mt Cook, from Hooker Lake. Photo Peter Ambrose
Apline General Category Honours, 2018 Wellington Section Photo Competition

Photo Comp 2018 Results

Our annual photo competition was concluded at our August Section night, when Peter Laurenson, a judge for the competition for the past four years, took those present through his thoughts about each entry and announced the seven category winners. Total entries were slightly down on last year's numbers, but the overall standard of entries was the best yet.

The Overall 'People's Choice' Winner, featured on this month's Vertigo cover, was chosen from the seven category winning entries by vote from those in the audience. Congratulations to the winners. Here and on the next two pages are the seven category winning entries with judge's comments.

Alpine General: Peter Ambrose

Stunning sunrise above Plateau Hut and the east face of Mt Cook

In my view a near perfect image - exposure, composition, considered subtle processing. The highlights are dramatic but never blown out. There is detail everywhere in the shadows. The colours are beautiful - perhaps a tad too much red but I'm not complaining. And a stunning, iconic subject.

If you're interested in learning more about how to approach and develop your outdoor photography, Peter has prepared an online presentation exploring four key aspects of outdoor photography:

Shooting manually

The hardware

Out on the hill

Back in the 'lab'

[More here](#)





Alpine Youth: Will Laurenson

Wind horses on Gokyo Ri

An outstanding picture. The different levels of light are all handled really well - none too dark or too light. The rays of the sun on the distant peaks contrast with the sunless peaks in the middle distance. The prayer flags that lead in from the bottom right-hand corner of the photo draw the viewer's eye towards the snow-fields and crags, while the prayer-flags in the bottom left-hand corner of the picture lead one's gaze towards the distant peaks. The two horizontal strings of flags give unity and an overall coherence to the picture.

<< Alpine Activity: Iain Burgon

Standing on an ice pillar, Canmore Canada

A jaw dropper. Vertical ice, lots of it - not normally a spot where climbers pause to take photos - fantastic. I'm not even sure which orientation is the intended view - with such verticality it works two ways. Technically good that even the foreground is in focus - accentuating the precarious stance. Perhaps a little contrasty, but a really memorable image.

Rock Climbing: Derek Cheng

Matthieu Laloup grimaces high above a watery atmosphere on The Moai. Ancient Astronaut (24), Fortescue Bay, Tasmania

A dramatic scene very well composed and exposed. The angle is right above, looking down the face, there is enough tower while leaving room to fully feature the rich textured seascape. We can easily see the climber's look of concentration - he looks remarkably relaxed given no top rope!





Alpine Nature: Shaun Barnett

Autumn beech leaf on moss, Kepler Track, Fiordland NP, Southland

A clear idea well executed - lovely exposure allowing shadow detail, sharp focus, rich complimentary colours and nice placement of the main subject. An aesthetically lovely nature image.



<< Alpine Humour: Derek Cheng

A core shot provokes a suitable reaction.
Yosemite National Park

This is a really interesting image. It makes fun of something pretty serious. The composition is very creative and very well executed technically. The expression is perfect for the caption. Nicely done.

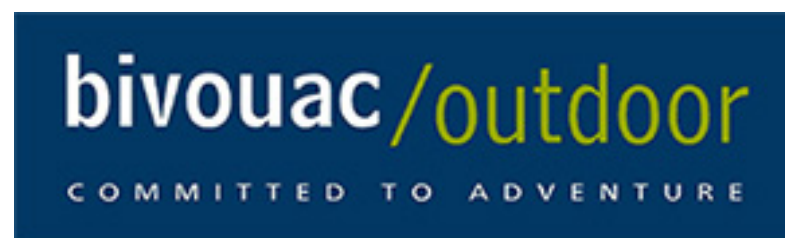
Alpine Culture: Derek Cheng

Good morning on El Cap Tower. The Nose, Yosemite, USA

Here is a well exposed image, composed to put the climbers position on the precarious ledge well in context. Everything is nicely in focus. I like how the front climber is rubbing his eyes after probably a fairly uncomfortable night. The others are busy getting ready for the next push. It is a strong climbing culture image taken from a place very hard to reach.



A big thank you to our Photo Competition Sponsors ...



Section Contacts

Powered by volunteers

We're always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. A lot goes on to keep our club going, virtually all powered by volunteers. On the back page is our "Club on a page" summary. It gives an at a glance description of all the things we do, how and why. Feel free to print a copy and pass it on to anyone who might be interested in becoming a member or volunteer. And if you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Role	Name	Contact
Chair person	Simon Williamson	021 054 7684
Secretary, gear custodian	Carolyn Ellis	021 574 287
Treasurer	Vacant	
Trip co-ordinator	Eric Duggan	021 350 161
Section nights, Vertigo, Photocomp	Peter Laurenson	021 446 725
Social media	Marie Kelly	
Club liaison	Keith Munro	
Library, Projects	Alex Waterworth	
General Committee	Matt Pemberton	
General Committee	Guy Dubuis	
General Committee	Joshua Mouat	
Patron	John Nankervis	
Rock drill overseer	Jeremy Tries	027 555 5893



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www.fergskayaks.co.nz

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Alpine Club members can climb any time for \$12
Monday nights show your Alpine Club card and climb for \$10



New routes every week*

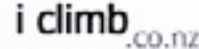
\$1000 worth of new holds in Jan/Feb 2012
New pad in "Da Cave" allowing safe aggressive bouldering

Creating happiness through better climbing

* to be precise, this is just an average but we do aim for new routes every single week.



HangDog Rock Climbing Adventures
453 Hutt Rd
Lower Hutt
(04) 589 9181
info@hangdog.co.nz
www.hangdog.co.nz



Simond alpine equipment direct from the importer



all crampons include anti-balling plates and crampon bag

Ocelot	MXC 820	Makalu	Caiman
\$115	\$230	\$255	\$230



For quick access to our Section's page on the NZAC website, click or scan this QR code



WHAT WE DO

FOR MEMBERS

Facilities

- * Huts
- * Gear
- * Library
- * Discounts

Training

- * Level 1- 3 winter skills
- * Summer rock
- * Instructors

Climbing trips

- * Section
- * National
- * International

FOR MEMBERS AND WIDER PUBLIC

Publications

- * Website
- * Social media
- * Vertigo
- * Guide books

Events

- * Banff mountain film festival
- * Reel Rock
- * Photo comp

Networking

- * Section nights
- * Conferences and meetings
- * Lobbying

HOW WE DO IT

Organise, encourage, support, enable

Inform, entertain, promote

OUR RESOURCES

Volunteer time and capabilities, income from events and gear hire, national office support, sponsorship

WHY WE DO IT

Connecting & developing more climbing & mountaineering people, knowledge, skills & experience, thereby ...

... building lifelong friendships

... protecting and improving access to alpine places

... sustaining and growing climbing and mountaineering achievement

... enhancing alpine safety

... building appreciation, enjoyment and protection of alpine places